Carson Slater web: https://carsonslater.github.io carsonslater7@gmail.com

# Cover Letter: Data Scientist – Servant

To the Data Science Hiring Committee at Servant,

I am a fourth-year Ph.D. candidate in the statistical science department at Baylor University writing to express my strong interest in the Data Scientist position at Servant. Servant's unique focus on guiding technology strategy and accelerating digital transformation for faith-based and mission-driven organizations is a mission I can gladly stand behind. As I complete my doctoral studies, I am looking for an opportunity to apply the advanced statistical methods and data science skills I have developed through my research and consulting projects. This Data Scientist role seems like the ideal environment to begin applying my expertise to help your clients scale their platforms and maximize their real-world impact.

I thrive in environments where I manage multiple complex projects simultaneously. During my time at Baylor, I have worked on contract projects with Denver Water to develop statistical methods for understanding residential water consumption using IoT meter data. This work involved developing data processing pipelines, combining diverse datasets, and crafting custom Shiny dashboards to assess and inform residential conservation efforts. Through feature engineering and market segmentation of approximately 200,000 homes, I discovered that roughly 20% of the customer base does not irrigate their outdoor spaces at all—an insight that led Denver Water's leadership to pivot from broad messaging to highly targeted, growth-oriented conservation strategies.

While I have no direct experience in the growth consulting industry, I excel at teaching myself both abstract theoretical concepts and deeply technical skills. Whether it is learning how to scrape external weather data for modeling or specifying complex priors for a Bayesian framework, I get into the weeds of a problem and translate those insights for both technical collaborators and non-technical stakeholders. A canonical example of this is my consulting work for the American Holistic Nursing Association, where I deployed mixed-effects models for longitudinal survey data to assess patient improvement. I partnered with peers to present our model findings in a parsimonious fashion to organizational stakeholders. My doctoral training has equipped me to adapt rapidly to new domains and teach myself nearly anything.

This Data Scientist role demands an individual who deeply understands both the nuances of statistical methodology—from machine learning algorithms (like PyTorch and XGBoost) to time-series forecasting—and the skills required to leverage big data. It also requires the self-motivation and rigorous time management that are prerequisites for completing a Ph.D. My background has equipped me to translate complex modeling into objective, actionable insights that will make a meaningful impact on Servant's strategic growth projects.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my technical background and dedication to data-driven stewardship make me a strong fit for your team.

Sincerely,

**Carson Slater**
PhD Candidate, Statistical Science
Baylor University